Geologic Period Infographic

U02 / S02.3

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

GROUP MEMBERS _____

THE JOB

Your group picks one geologic period and makes an infographic about it. An infographic tells its story with pictures, a map, and short labels, not paragraphs. The menu on page 2 lists every period you can choose from so you can compare before you decide. Page 3 shows an example setup. The infographic has to be in color.

WHAT GOES ON THE INFOGRAPHIC

1. **Title.** The name of your period, large enough to read from across the room. Add when it started and ended, in millions of years ago (mya).
2. **Timeline bar.** A strip showing where your period sits in its era, with your period highlighted.
3. **Key Facts zone. Climate:** warm or cold, wet or dry, ice or no ice. **Continents:** a colored map of where the continents were, each one labeled.
4. **Organisms.** At least 3 important living things that evolved or first appeared in your period (the first dinosaurs, the first flowering plants). Each gets a picture, its name, and a one-line caption on why it matters.
5. **Short text only.** Labels and one-line captions. No paragraphs.
6. **Color.** The whole infographic is in color, not pencil or pen alone.

BLANK LAYOUT

PERIOD NAME

start and end dates, in mya

TIMELINE BAR

KEY FACTS

CLIMATE
warm or cold, wet or dry, ice or no ice

CONTINENTS MAP
colored, each continent labeled

ORGANISMS

At least 3. Picture, name, one-line caption. Add frames if you have more.

ORGANISM 1	ORGANISM 2	ORGANISM 3
picture, name, caption	picture, name, caption	picture, name, caption

Solid teal border: Key Facts. Dashed black border: Organisms. Where the zones sit is up to your group.

CHOOSE YOUR PERIOD

The Menu: 12 Periods

mya = million years ago. Oldest at the top, youngest at the bottom. Use this to pick, then get the full facts from your class notes.

PERIOD	CLIMATE	NEW LIFE	CONTINENTS
PALEOZOIC ERA · 539 TO 252 MYA			
Cambrian 539 to 485 mya	Warm. Shallow seas flooded the edges of the continents.	The Cambrian explosion: first animals with hard shells and eyes. Trilobites, Anomalocaris. Animals live only in the ocean.	Gondwana, a big continent mostly in the south. Smaller continents scattered near the equator.
Ordovician 485 to 444 mya ENDS: MASS EXTINCTION	Warm with very high sea level, then an ice age near the end.	First land plants (small, mossy). Big coral reefs. Fish with no jaws. *Ohio's state invertebrate fossil, the trilobite Isotelus, is from this period.*	Gondwana over the South Pole. Ohio sat under a warm shallow sea.
Silurian 444 to 419 mya	Warm. Ice melted and seas rose again.	Early vascular plants (Cooksonia). Earliest jawed fish. Sea scorpions.	Two northern continents, Laurentia and Baltica, collide and close an ocean between them.
Devonian 419 to 359 mya ENDS: MASS EXTINCTION	Mostly warm. Cooling toward the end.	The Age of Fishes: armored Dunkleosteus, early sharks. First forests. First four-legged animals. Tiktaalik, a fish with leg-like fins, shows how they evolved. *Dunkleosteus fossils come from the Cleveland Shale.*	North America and Europe joined into one northern continent. Gondwana still in the south.
Carboniferous 359 to 299 mya	Warm and wet with huge swamps near the equator. Ice sheets in the far south.	Swamp forests that became coal. First reptiles. Dragonfly-like insects with wings about 2 ft across. *Eastern Ohio's coal formed in these swamps.*	Gondwana and the northern continent collide. Pangaea starts to form.
Permian 299 to 252 mya ENDS: MASS EXTINCTION	Cold at first, with ice sheets in the south. Later hot and dry, with big deserts inside Pangaea.	Dimetrodon and other mammal relatives. Conifers spread. First beetles. Ends with the worst mass extinction ever: roughly 9 of every 10 ocean species died.	One supercontinent: Pangaea.
MESOZOIC ERA · 252 TO 66 MYA			
Triassic 252 to 201 mya ENDS: MASS EXTINCTION	Hot, mostly dry. No ice at the poles.	First dinosaurs. First mammals (small). First pterosaurs. Early turtles. Ichthyosaurs in the sea.	Pangaea, still in one piece. It begins to crack apart near the end.
Jurassic 201 to 145 mya	Warm and humid. No ice caps.	Stegosaurus. Giant long-necked dinosaurs. Archaeopteryx, an early bird. Plesiosaurs in the sea.	Pangaea splits into a northern and a southern continent. The Atlantic Ocean starts to open.
Cretaceous 145 to 66 mya ENDS: MASS EXTINCTION	Very warm. Highest sea level of the dinosaur age; a shallow sea cut North America in two.	First flowering plants. Tyrannosaurus rex and Triceratops. An asteroid hit about 66 mya and ended the non-bird dinosaurs.	Continents keep splitting. South America and Africa separate. India drifts north.
CENOZOIC ERA · 66 MYA TO TODAY			
Paleogene 66 to 23 mya	Hot early on, then cooling. Ice starts to build on Antarctica.	Mammals take over the empty spaces left by the dinosaurs. First whales, first horses, early primates.	Looks closer to today. India crashes into Asia and the Himalaya begin to rise.
Neogene 23 to 2.6 mya	Cooling and drying. Large Antarctic ice sheets.	Grasslands spread, and so do grazing animals. Early human ancestors (Australopithecus). Mastodon relatives appear.	Almost the modern map. North and South America connect at Panama. Scientists still debate when: about 3 mya, or possibly earlier.
Quaternary 2.6 mya to today	Repeating ice ages. Sea level dropped each time ice grew. *Ice sheets covered much of Ohio.*	Woolly mammoths, saber-toothed cats, and the first Homo sapiens (about 300,000 years ago). Many large mammals died out about 11,000 years ago.	Nearly the same positions as today.

EXAMPLE SETUP

What a Finished Infographic Looks Like

EXAMPLE Sample layout using the Triassic. Choose a different period for yours. This copy is outlined to save printer ink. Yours must be colored in.

TRIASSIC

252 to 201 mya · 51 million years · Mesozoic Era

TRIASSIC	JURASSIC	CRETACEOUS

Timeline bar: the Mesozoic Era, with our period highlighted.

KEY FACTS

CLIMATE
Hot and mostly dry. No ice at the poles.

CONTINENTS: one supercontinent, Pangaea

ORGANISMS

drawing of Coelophysis

Coelophysis
An early dinosaur from the Late Triassic. Small, fast, and walked on two legs.

drawing of Eudimorphodon

Eudimorphodon
An early pterosaur. Pterosaurs were the first backboned animals to fly under their own power.

drawing of an ichthyosaur

Ichthyosaur
A marine reptile. Later ones looked like dolphins.

HOW THIS EXAMPLE MEETS THE JOB

1. Big title with the dates. The name is the biggest thing on the page.
2. The timeline bar shows where the Triassic sits and highlights it.
3. Key Facts holds climate and the continents map, side by side.
4. Three organisms, each with a picture, a name, and a one-line caption.
5. Only labels and short captions. Nothing longer than one sentence.

Group Plan and Rubric

OUR GROUP PLAN

Our period	
Organism 1	
Organism 2	
Organism 3	
Who makes the timeline and continents map	
Who writes the climate section	

RUBRIC · 20 POINTS

PART	FULL CREDIT	PARTIAL	LITTLE OR NONE	SCORE
Title and timeline 3 points	**3.** Period name and dates are big and clear. Timeline bar shows where the period sits and highlights it.	**1 to 2.** One is missing, or hard to read.	**0.** Neither.	
Climate 3 points	**3.** Correct. Says warm or cold, wet or dry, and gives one specific detail such as ice, deserts, swamps, or sea level.	**1 to 2.** One word like "hot" with no detail, or partly incorrect.	**0.** Missing or wrong.	
Continents map 3 points	**3.** Map shows where the continents were in this period. Each continent is labeled.	**1 to 2.** Map is there but unlabeled, or only partly matches the period.	**0.** No map, or just today's map.	
Organisms and pictures 5 points	**5.** At least 3 important organisms that were common or first appeared in this period. Each has a labeled picture and a one-line caption on why it matters.	**2 to 4.** Fewer than 3, or one is from a different time, or pictures or captions are missing.	**0 to 1.** One organism or none.	
Clear and visual 3 points	**3.** Tells the story with pictures and short labels. No paragraphs. Zones are easy to find and readable from a few feet away.	**1 to 2.** Too much writing, or crowded and hard to follow.	**0.** Mostly paragraphs.	
Color 3 points	**3.** The whole infographic is colored, and the color helps show what goes together.	**1 to 2.** Color in some parts only.	**0.** Mostly black and white.	
			TOTAL	**/ 20**